5. Chronological Classification

Under this method various records are identified and arranged in strict date order and sometimes even according to the time of the day. It is a useful method for filing invoices and other vouchers associated with accounts.

This system may be useful if used along with some other system. The records may be arranged alphabetically first and then can be arranged date-wise within each folder. So this system cannot be used independently.



Fig. 5.9. Chronological classification

5.5. Indexing:

Index is anything that "points out" or indicates. Indexing can be described as a method of providing indicators for a body of data or collection of records. The term "indexing" should not be confused with the term "classification". Classification is the method of filing while indexing is basically the method used for making reference to the matter filed.



Fig. 5.10. Indexing

5.5.1. Objectives of Indexing:

The principal objective of indexing is to assist filing so that filed papers are located easily and quickly whenever they are needed. Indexing thus adds to the efficiency of the filing method. It ensures speed and consequently economy results due to increased speed. The objective of indexing is best achieved where the right type of indexing system is chosen. Where files are arranged in geographical-cum-alphabetical or only alphabetical order, an index is not needed. However, in other systems of classification, it becomes essential to provide an index for customers, suppliers, credit ratings telephone numbers and soon. Index is also required for different kinds of registers and ledgers.

5.5.2. Essentials of a Good system of Indexing:

In order to achieve its objectives, a good system of indexing should have the following essential features;

1. It should be simple.
2. It should be economical in operation.
3. It should allow for speed.

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